Research Report

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2026-03-23

Summary of Revisions Since Draft 1

This page summarizes the main revisions made in response to feedback on the first draft.

- Revised the introduction to describe variables in substantive terms rather than primarily by code-style variable names.
- Clarified the data source, snapshot nature of the dataset, and observational scope of the study.
- Removed the report-body note about the local file path and kept that reproducibility detail in the R script instead.
- Expanded the data-preparation section to explain missing values, including why rows with missing prices were excluded and why the two observations missing fast-charging speed are unlikely to affect the fitted models materially.
- Added a note that extracted manufacturer names were manually checked after cleaning.
- Added justification that repeated model names appear to be distinct listings or configurations, so retaining them does not appear to directly violate the working independence assumption.
- Replaced the original price boxplot with a histogram to better display the distribution of vehicle prices.
- Revised the exploratory-analysis section so the price histogram, summary table, and price-versus-battery plot are the main figures tied to the research question.
- Added appendix figures showing the distributions of battery capacity and driving range by segment, price against additional technical variables, and broader pairwise relationships among quantitative variables.
- Reduced the amount of detailed discussion of the simple exploratory regressions and shortened the correlation discussion so it functions mainly as a transition into the multiple-regression analysis.
- Revised the modeling-strategy section to use more formal wording, clarified that the initial raw-price model contains all covariates, and explained the backward partial-F-test procedure more clearly.
- Strengthened the justification for the log transformation by linking it to the right-skewness and heteroscedasticity observed in the exploratory analysis and diagnostics.
- Expanded the interpretation of the battery and range coefficients to explain why battery capacity is not statistically significant in the adjusted non-premium model and what that coefficient represents after controlling for related variables.
- Revised the interaction interpretation to focus more clearly on the difference between premium and non-premium pricing patterns.
- Added clearer references to appendix diagnostics and explained the Cook's distance reference line.
- Tightened the discussion and conclusion so they align more directly with the final fitted model.

Introduction

Electric vehicle (EV) prices vary substantially across models, even among vehicles with similar technical specifications. Battery capacity is one of the most visible EV characteristics and is often associated with both production cost and consumer value. However, vehicle price is not determined by battery capacity alone. Manufacturers differ in brand positioning, and premium brands may charge systematically higher prices than non-premium brands even for vehicles with similar specifications. Understanding this relationship is important for both consumers and manufacturers. For consumers, it helps clarify whether higher prices reflect meaningful technical improvements or brand positioning. For manufacturers, it provides insight into how battery capacity is translated into pricing across different market segments.

This report studies EV models listed for sale in Germany and investigates whether battery capacity is associated with vehicle price, and whether that association differs between premium and non-premium manufacturers. The research questions are:

1. Among electric vehicle models listed for sale in Germany, is battery capacity positively associated with vehicle price?
2. Does the association between battery capacity and price differ between premium and non-premium manufacturers?

The data come from the *Electric Vehicle Specifications and Prices* dataset obtained from Kaggle and compiled by web scraping EV Database. EV Database aggregates manufacturer-reported technical specifications and listed prices for electric vehicle models listed for sale in Germany. The Kaggle dataset page indicates that the dataset entry was updated "2 years ago," which provides some background on when the posted dataset was last refreshed. However, that platform update note should not be interpreted as a precise statement of the model year coverage or the exact scrape date of the underlying EV listings. The dataset contains 360 observations, where each row represents a distinct EV model. This dataset should not be interpreted as a complete census of all electric vehicles that have ever existed or all EVs ever sold in Germany. Instead, it is best understood as a snapshot of the EV models included in EV Database when the source was scraped and the Kaggle dataset was assembled. The exact calendar year or scrape date is not stated in the raw CSV used here, so the report avoids treating the data as representing a single fully specified year. Since the data are observational rather than experimental, all conclusions in this report are associative rather than causal.

The response variable is the listed vehicle price in euros, which captures the manufacturer's suggested retail price for each electric vehicle in the German market. The main explanatory variable is battery capacity, measured in kilowatt-hours (kWh), which reflects the total energy storage available in the vehicle and is closely tied to both cost and performance. A second key variable is manufacturer segment, coded as premium or non-premium. Following the proposal, Tesla, BMW, Audi, Mercedes-Benz, and Porsche are classified as premium brands based on their widely recognized positioning in the European automotive market. This grouping is intended to reflect broad brand-tier differences rather than a formal regulatory classification. Other quantitative variables considered during model building include driving range, which measures how far a vehicle can travel on a single charge; energy efficiency, which captures how effectively the vehicle converts stored energy into distance traveled; top speed, the maximum speed the vehicle can achieve; acceleration, measured as the time in seconds required to go from 0 to 100 km/h; and fast-charging speed, which indicates how quickly the battery can be replenished using a rapid charging system. No major data transformations were applied to the variables. In particular, all quantitative variables were analyzed on their original scales. The only modification was to simplify the analysis by not distinguishing between specific vehicle models, and instead grouping vehicles at the manufacturer level through the premium versus non-premium classification.

This report uses multiple linear regression because the response is continuous and the main goal is inference about average relationships. In particular, including an interaction between battery capacity and market segment allows the battery-price relationship to differ between premium and non-premium manufacturers, which directly addresses the second research question. Variables named in the research questions are retained throughout model selection regardless of whether a selection procedure would otherwise remove them, as removing them would prevent direct interpretation of the parameters of primary interest.

Exploratory Analysis

Data Preparation

The raw file contains 360 observations and 9 recorded variables: `Battery`, `Car_name`, `Car_name_link`, `Efficiency`, `Fast_charge`, `Price.DE.`, `Range`, `Top_speed`, and `acceleration..0.100..` Because the data were scraped from an online database, the observed models reflect what EV Database included during the underlying collection period, not necessarily every EV available in the German market before or after that time. This matters for interpretation: the analysis is best understood as describing relationships among the EV models represented in this snapshot, rather than making claims about the broader German EV market.

Of the 9 variables, two contain missing values: the listed price in euros has 51 missing entries, and fast-charging speed has 2. Examination of the 51 observations with missing price reveals that they fall predominantly into identifiable categories — Chinese brands with limited official presence in the German market (such as Hongqi and XPENG), newly released models that had not yet received official German pricing at the time of data collection, commercial vehicles typically sold through fleet or quote-based arrangements, and ultra-luxury models for which public list prices are not routinely published. This pattern suggests the missing values are not random but are systematically related to market availability and pricing practices. Since price is the response variable, these 51 rows cannot contribute to the regression and are removed. The two observations with missing fast-charging speed are handled differently: they are retained in the working dataset and excluded only from models that include fast-charging speed as a predictor. Inspection of these two observations shows that their battery capacity and price fall close to the overall sample means, suggesting they are unlikely to be influential points, and their exclusion is not expected to meaningfully affect the fitted models.

To prepare the analysis dataset, a manufacturer variable was extracted from the vehicle name, the premium/non-premium grouping from the proposal was applied, the acceleration variable was renamed to a cleaner label, and only the variables relevant to the analysis were retained. Identifier variables such as `Car_name_link` were not used as predictors because they do not have an interpretable statistical relationship with price. Manufacturer names were extracted by taking the first word of the vehicle name. For multi-word brands such as Mercedes-Benz, a correction was applied explicitly in the code. The full list of extracted manufacturer names was manually reviewed, and no remaining misclassifications were identified in the dataset.

After removing rows with missing price, the main analysis dataset contains 309 EV models. A check of duplicate `Car_name` values shows that some names appear more than once. These rows were retained because they are not exact duplicates of the full record. In several cases, the repeated names correspond to different EV Database links and slightly different technical specifications, which suggests updated entries or distinct configurations rather than accidental duplication. For example, duplicated Mercedes entries often appear as an older version with missing price and a newer version with a reported price, while the duplicated Mini Cooper SE entries differ substantially in battery capacity and range and therefore represent genuinely different configurations. Because these repeated names appear to represent distinct listings rather than repeated measurements of the same vehicle record, retaining them does not appear to create a direct violation of the working independence assumption used in the regression analysis.

For the main regression, one practical choice is to fit models using complete cases on the variables included in each model. If `Fast_charge` remains in a candidate model, the effective sample size becomes 307 rather than 309 because of the two missing charging values. This should be noted when comparing models. To assess whether the 51 models with missing prices appeared systematically different from the retained models, the observed technical variables were compared across the two groups during data preparation. Those comparisons did not suggest large differences in battery capacity, range, efficiency, top speed, acceleration, or fast-charge capability, which reduces concern that the missing prices are concentrated only among very low-end or very high-end vehicles. However, because the missingness mechanism is not known, some selection bias remains possible.

Exploratory Summaries

Exploratory analysis serves two purposes in this study. First, it helps describe the data to readers who are not familiar with the EV market. Second, it helps identify features of the data that affect the regression analysis, such as skewness, segment differences, and multicollinearity among technical variables.

Start with summary statistics (Table 1) for the response and candidate explanatory variables.

Table 1: Summary statistics for key quantitative variables

N	Mean price	Median price	SD price	Mean battery	Median battery	SD battery	Mean range	Mean efficiency
309	67264.28	56942	34508.25	71.08	70.5	20.65	369.13	195.41

The 309 EV models used in the main analysis have a mean listed price of 67,264 EUR and a median price of 56,942 EUR, suggesting some right-skewness caused by a smaller number of high-priced vehicles (Table 1). Battery capacity is more balanced, with a mean of 71.1 kWh and a median of 70.5 kWh. Overall, the summary statistics indicate that price is more variable than battery capacity. Additional grouped summaries, not shown in Table 1, indicate that premium vehicles tend to have both larger batteries and higher listed prices on average than non-premium vehicles. These patterns motivate examining the joint relationship between price, battery capacity, and market segment in the regression analysis.

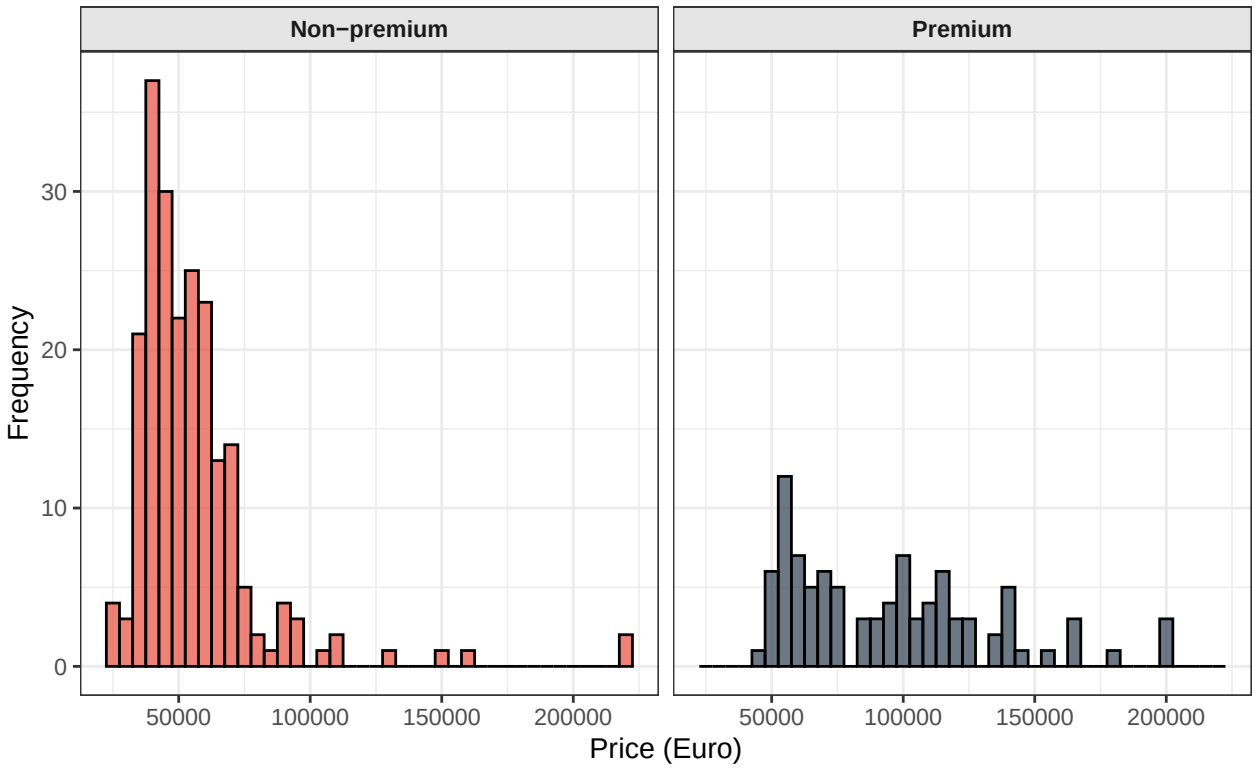


Figure 1: Distribution of EV prices by market segment

The histogram of vehicle prices shows clear right-skewness in both market segments (Figure 1). Most vehicles are concentrated in the lower-to-middle price ranges, with a smaller number of high-priced vehicles extending the upper tail. The premium segment is also more dispersed and shifted toward higher prices than the non-premium segment. These features are consistent with the summary statistics in Table 1 and suggest that a transformation of price may be useful in the regression analysis.

Other quantitative variables were also explored to understand how the two segments differ beyond price alone. Appendix Figure A1 shows the distributions of battery capacity and driving range by segment. Premium vehicles tend to have both larger batteries and longer ranges, and their distributions are more spread out than those of non-premium vehicles. Appendix Figure A2 complements this by plotting price against several additional technical variables, showing that price also tends to increase with range and top speed, while lower acceleration times are generally associated with higher prices. These broader exploratory patterns help motivate the later inclusion of multiple technical controls rather than focusing on battery capacity alone.

The main exploratory visualization plots price against battery capacity with separate fitted lines for premium and non-premium manufacturers (Figure 2). This figure directly addresses both research questions by showing both the overall battery-price association and the extent to which that association may differ by market segment.

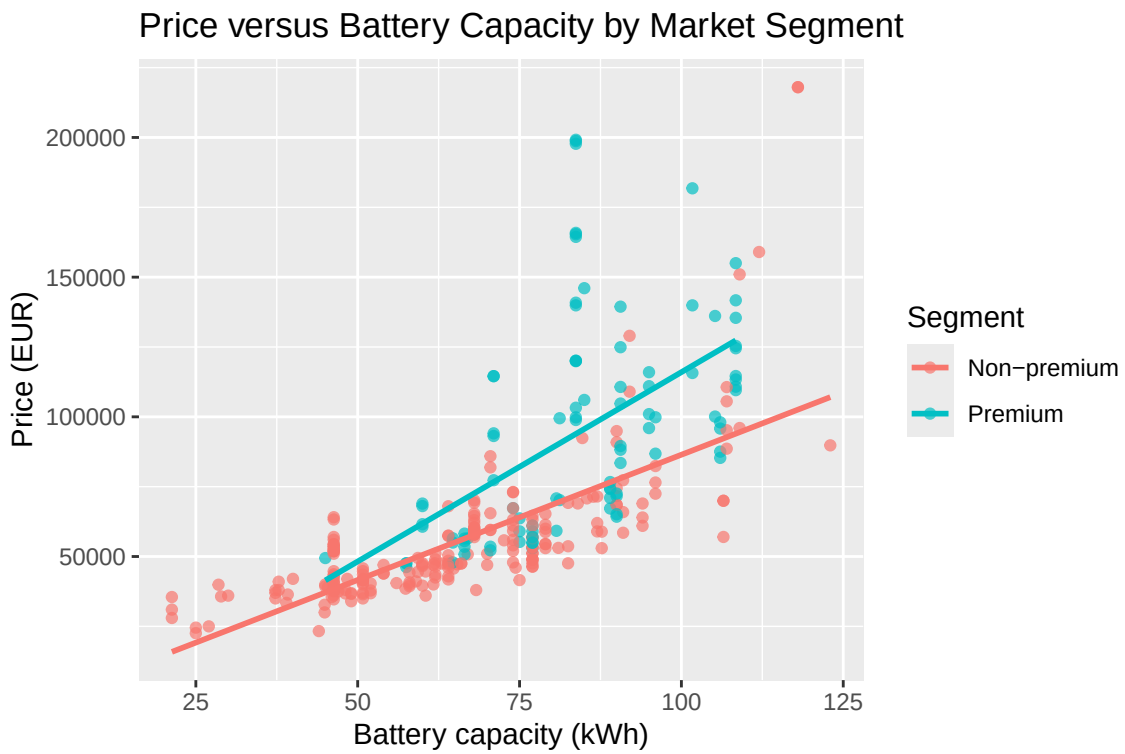


Figure 2: Price versus battery capacity by market segment

To complement Figure 2, Table 2 summarizes simple within-segment slopes from separate regressions of price on battery capacity. The estimated relationship is positive in both segments and steeper for premium vehicles, which is consistent with the visual pattern in Figure 2. Because these simple regressions are included only for exploratory comparison, the main inferential conclusions are based on the multiple-regression models developed in the next section.

Table 2: Estimated battery-price relationship by market segment

Segment	Slope estimate (EUR/kWh)	Standard error	p-value
Non-premium	896.68	57.47	<0.001
Premium	1355.14	222.63	<0.001

Because several technical variables may measure overlapping aspects of vehicle performance, their pairwise

correlations were also examined (Table 3). In particular, battery capacity is highly correlated with driving range (0.88), and top speed is strongly negatively correlated with acceleration time (-0.84). These patterns suggest that some predictors contain overlapping information, which is important to keep in mind when fitting and interpreting the multiple-regression model. Broader pairwise relationships are shown in Appendix Figure A3.

Table 3: Correlation matrix for quantitative variables

	Price.DE.	Battery	Range	Efficiency	Top_speed	Acceleration_0_100	Fast_charge
Price.DE.	1.00	0.70	0.59	0.17	0.76	-0.53	0.62
Battery	0.70	1.00	0.88	0.16	0.70	-0.61	0.59
Range	0.59	0.88	1.00	-0.31	0.76	-0.75	0.72
Efficiency	0.17	0.16	-0.31	1.00	-0.21	0.42	-0.29
Top_speed	0.76	0.70	0.76	-0.21	1.00	-0.84	0.79
Acceleration_0_100	-0.53	-0.61	-0.75	0.42	-0.84	1.00	-0.68
Fast_charge	0.62	0.59	0.72	-0.29	0.79	-0.68	1.00

Statistical Analysis

Modeling Strategy

The study employs a multiple linear regression framework because the response variable is continuous and the goal is inference about average relationships. The model is built around the research-question terms: battery capacity (*Battery*), market segment (*market_segment*), and their interaction. These terms are retained throughout model selection so that both research questions remain directly addressable. Additional technical variables, including *Range*, *Efficiency*, *Top_speed*, *Acceleration*_0_100, and *Fast_charge*, are treated as additional candidate variables considered during model selection.

Backward elimination based on partial F-tests (implemented using drop1() in R) is used for the additional candidate variables only. Variables with p-values greater than 0.05 are removed sequentially. This test-based approach is appropriate here because the project focuses on inference rather than prediction. Other criteria such as information criteria could also be considered, but a test-based approach is used here because the emphasis is on retaining variables that contribute inferentially once the research-question terms are fixed. Starting from the full model allows each candidate variable to be assessed while the others are present, and it helps reduce the model to a more interpretable form without removing the terms required by the research questions.

Initial Model

In the raw price model (i.e., the model containing all covariates), the adjusted R^2 is approximately 0.7313. However, we must verify if the assumptions of linear regression hold before trusting these results.

Diagnostic Discovery

A systematic review of the initial raw-price model's diagnostics revealed critical violations of Gauss-Markov assumptions:

- Heteroscedasticity: The "Residuals vs Fitted" plot displayed a prominent fan-shaped pattern, indicating that the error variance increases as the predicted price rises.
- Non-Normality: The Normal Q-Q plot exhibited a heavy upper tail, suggesting the residuals are right-skewed—a common trait in monetary datasets where high-end outliers are present.

Because these violations could lead to unstable coefficient estimates and unreliable p-values, we transition to a log-linear framework to stabilize the variance.

Model Refinement: Log-Transformation

To address the heteroscedasticity and the right-skewness observed in the exploratory analysis, we applied a natural log transformation ($log(Price)$). The backward-elimination procedure was then repeated using the log-transformed response.

Diagnostics and Model Selection

Initial diagnostics of the untransformed price model revealed meaningful departures from the linear-model assumptions. As shown in Appendix Figure A4, the residual-versus-fitted plot displayed increasing spread as fitted values increased, and the Q-Q plot showed a heavy upper tail, indicating heteroscedasticity and right-skewness in price. In addition, several technical variables (e.g., Battery and Range) were found to be highly correlated, raising concerns about multicollinearity and motivating careful variable selection.

The log transformation of price reduced these problems and improved model fit, with adjusted R^2 increasing from 0.7313 to 0.8412. Some mild upper-tail deviation remains in the Q-Q plot after transformation, but it is not severe enough to overturn the main inferential conclusions. These diagnostic plots are provided in Appendix Figure A4 and Appendix Figure A5 and are referenced here to support the model choice. For these reasons, the log-linear model is used as the primary inferential model in the report.

Main Model Results (log linear)

The final model was fitted on 307 observations, as 2 additional rows were excluded due to missing values in `Fast_charge`. Final coefficient estimates are reported in Table 4. After backward elimination, `Acceleration_0_100` was removed, while `Range`, `Efficiency`, `Top_speed`, and `Fast_charge` were retained as control variables. The adjusted R^2 for the final log-price model is 0.8412.

In this adjusted model, the coefficient for `Battery` in the baseline non-premium segment is not statistically significant ($p = 0.1517$). This suggests that, once driving range and other performance measures are accounted for, battery capacity by itself is not a key determinant of price in non-premium vehicles. This is plausible given the strong correlation between `Battery` and `Range` ($r = 0.88$). Since `Range` is retained in the model, it captures much of the variation associated with battery capacity, leaving the coefficient for `Battery` to reflect only the remaining variation beyond driving range. In practical terms, once `Range` is already in the model, the battery coefficient asks whether two vehicles with the same range but different battery capacities still differ in price, which is a much narrower question than the simple battery-price relationship. As a result, the model should be interpreted as assessing the association of battery capacity with price after holding constant several related measures of vehicle performance.

Table 4: Coefficient estimates for the final regression model

	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)	8.0131	0.2184	36.6899	0.0000
Battery	-0.0047	0.0033	-1.4371	0.1517
market_segmentPremium	-0.3002	0.1120	-2.6802	0.0078
Range	0.0018	0.0006	2.8726	0.0044
Efficiency	0.0075	0.0010	7.4841	0.0000
Top_speed	0.0057	0.0005	10.5893	0.0000
Fast_charge	0.0003	0.0001	3.7778	0.0002
Battery:market_segmentPremium	0.0051	0.0013	3.7781	0.0002

Interpretation of Results

Interaction Between Battery Capacity and Segment The interaction term between `Battery` and `market_segmentPremium` is positive and highly significant ($\beta = 0.0051$, $p < 0.001$), indicating that the relationship between battery capacity and price differs between premium and non-premium vehicles.

In practical terms, this means that battery capacity is more strongly associated with higher prices for premium vehicles than for non-premium vehicles. Even after controlling for other performance-related variables, premium brands tend to place greater value on larger battery capacities, while this effect is much weaker for non-premium vehicles.

For non-premium vehicles, battery capacity is not a statistically significant predictor of price once other factors are accounted for. This suggests that consumers in this segment may care more about overall performance measures (such as range and efficiency) rather than battery size itself.

In contrast, for premium vehicles, the positive interaction indicates that increases in battery capacity are more likely to be reflected in higher prices. Overall, the key takeaway is that the effect of battery capacity on price is not uniform across segments: it plays a more important role in pricing for premium vehicles than for non-premium ones.

Control Variables The retained control variables also help explain the pricing patterns. `Range` ($p = 0.0044$), `Top_speed` ($p < 2 \times 10^{-16}$), and `Efficiency` ($p < 0.001$) each contribute information beyond battery capacity alone, indicating that the market values a broader set of performance characteristics. Their inclusion also helps explain why the adjusted coefficient for battery capacity is much smaller than the simple within-segment slopes reported in Table 2.

Discussion and Conclusion

Discussion

Taken together, the exploratory and regression results suggest that battery capacity is associated with EV price, but that relationship depends on how price is modeled and which other technical variables are held fixed. In the adjusted log-linear model, much of the association between battery capacity and price is explained by other correlated performance measures such as range and top speed. As a result, the battery coefficient is not statistically significant for non-premium vehicles, while the positive interaction term indicates that the battery–price relationship remains stronger in the premium segment.

This pattern is consistent with the idea that EV prices reflect a bundle of related technical characteristics rather than battery capacity alone. For non-premium vehicles in particular, battery size may matter mainly through the performance outcomes it helps produce, such as longer range or higher speed, rather than as an independently priced feature. For premium vehicles, the positive interaction suggests that battery capacity is more closely aligned with pricing even after controlling for those related characteristics, although the adjusted premium slope itself is small in the final model.

Limitations

Several limitations should be kept in mind. First, the dataset is an observational snapshot of EV models listed in EV Database and does not represent all EVs sold in Germany or all EVs from a clearly specified year. Second, the premium versus non-premium classification is a simplified grouping based on widely recognized market positioning rather than a formal industry standard. Third, some relevant determinants of price, such as interior quality, software features, or driver-assistance packages, are not recorded in the dataset. Finally, because 51 observations had missing prices and were excluded, some risk of selection bias remains even though the missing-price models do not appear dramatically different on the observed technical variables.

Conclusion

The analysis provides evidence that the association between battery capacity and EV price differs by market segment. Premium vehicles exhibit a steeper unadjusted battery-price relationship, and the adjusted log-linear model also indicates a significant difference between premium and non-premium segments through the interaction term. At the same time, the final model shows that battery capacity alone does not have a clear independent association with price for non-premium vehicles once other related technical variables

are held constant. Overall, the results suggest that EV pricing reflects both battery capacity and broader performance characteristics, and that these relationships are not the same across manufacturer segments.

Statement of AI Use

Generative AI was used to help organize the structure and wording of this report and to assist in preparing a separate reproducible analysis script. The statistical conclusions, numerical results, and model interpretations are based on outputs generated from the dataset itself.

Representative prompts used:

1. "Help revise the writing so the report reads like a formal statistical report rather than notebook-style notes."
2. "Help update the data-preparation description so it accurately reflects the raw dataset, missing values, and derived variables used in the analysis."
3. "Help strengthen the wording in response to feedback on interaction interpretation, diagnostics, model selection, and limitations."
4. "Help move less essential material to the appendix so the main body remains concise and within the page limit."

Appendix

Supplementary Figures

Figure A1

Distributions of Battery Capacity and Driving Range by Market Segment

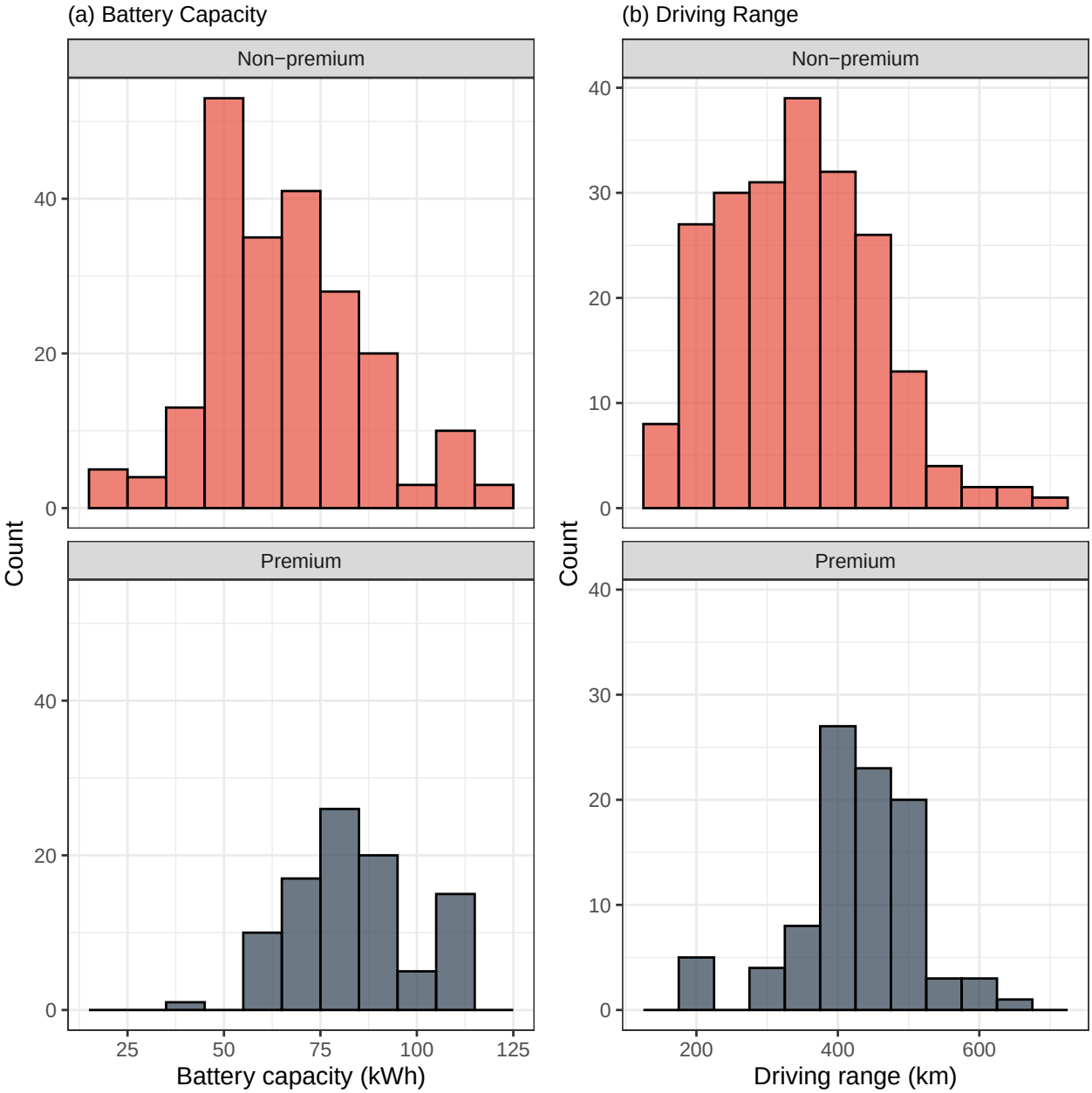


Figure A2

Price versus Additional Technical Variables by Market Segment

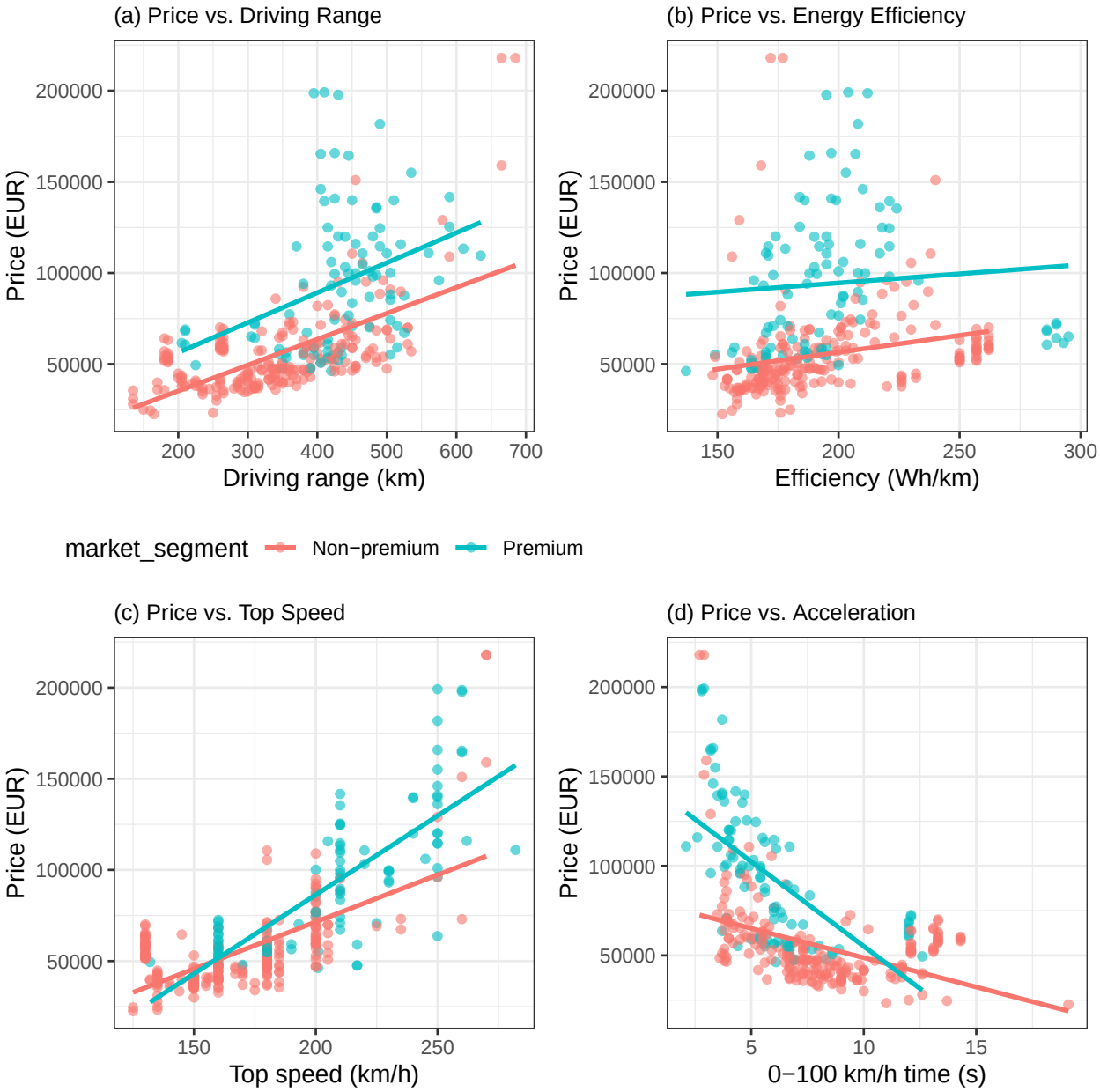
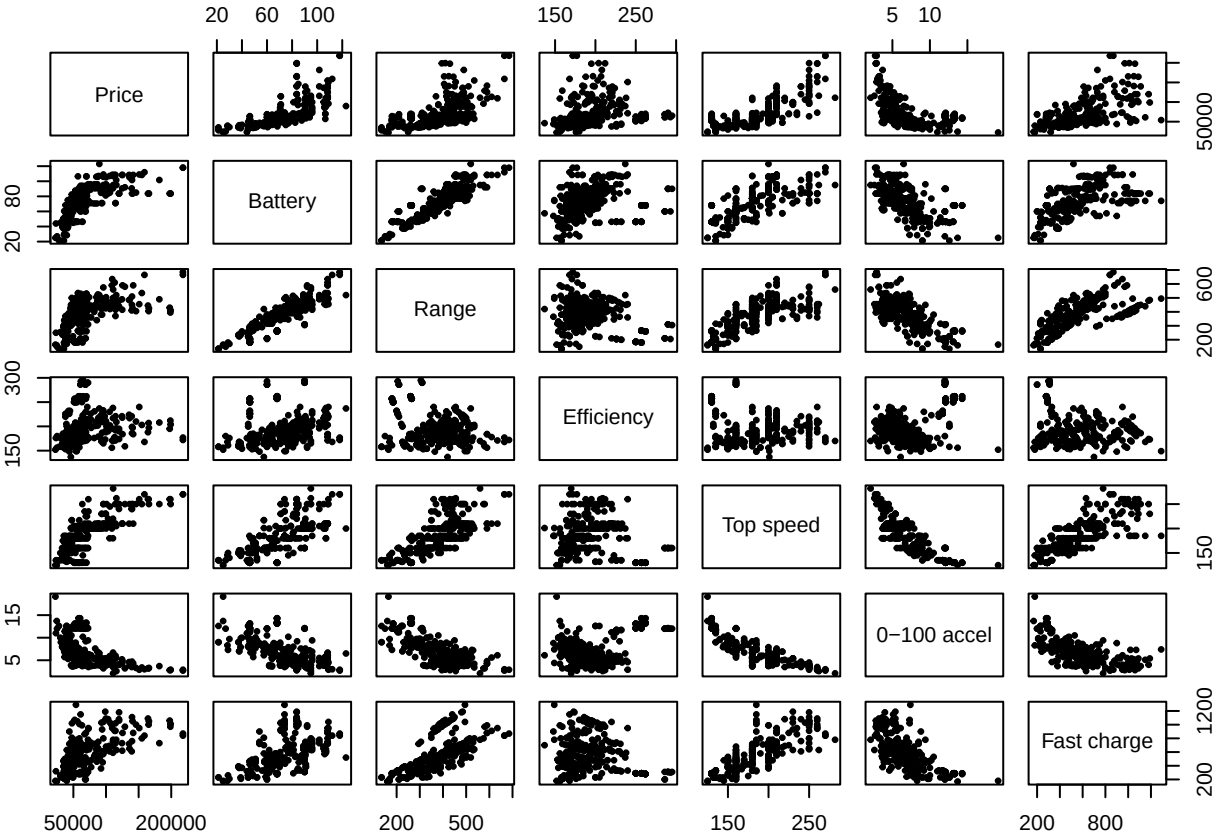


Figure A3

Scatterplot Matrix for Quantitative Variables Used in the Analysis



The scatterplot matrix in Appendix Figure A3 is mainly helpful for visually checking which explanatory variables appear strongly associated with price and which predictors appear highly related to one another. In this dataset, it supports the conclusion that variables such as `Battery`, `Range`, `Top_speed`, and `Fast_charge` share substantial overlap, which helps explain why a simpler final model is preferred.

Figure A4

Diagnostic Plots for the Selected Regression Model

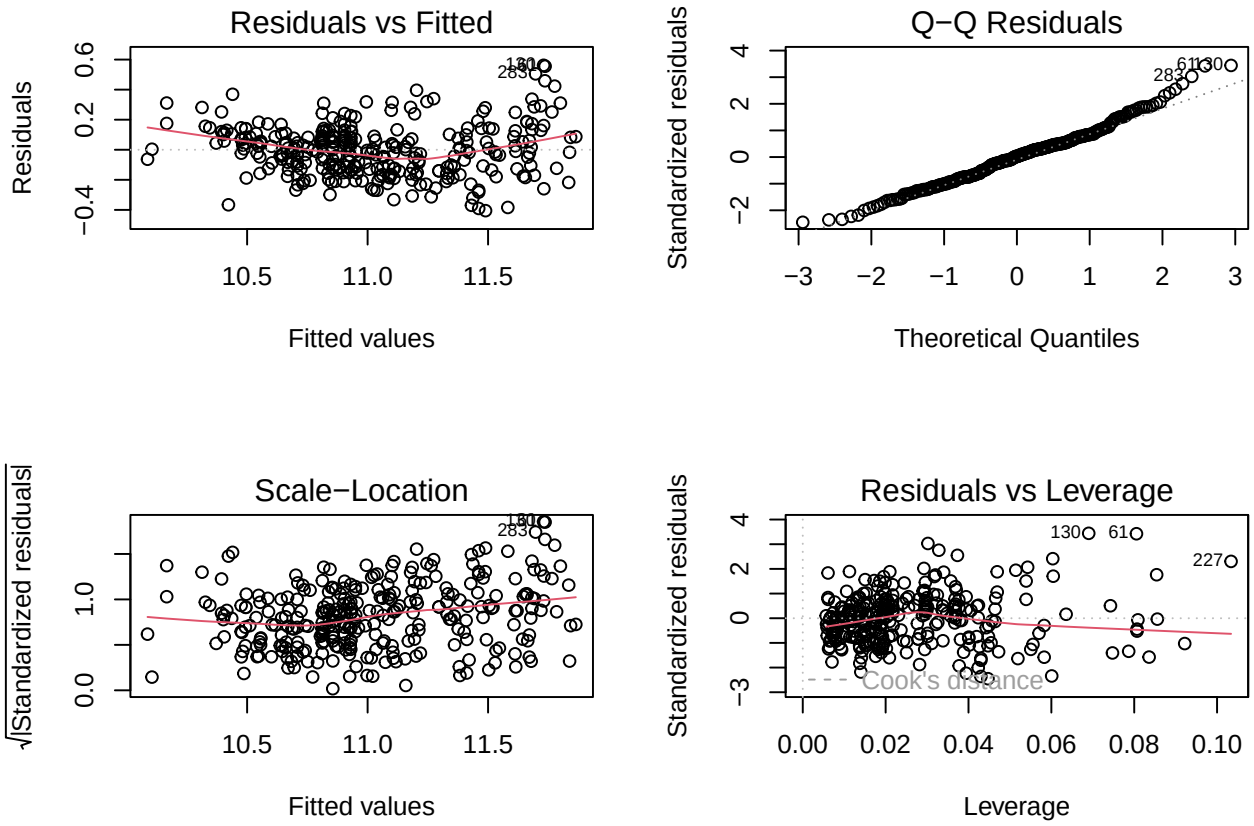
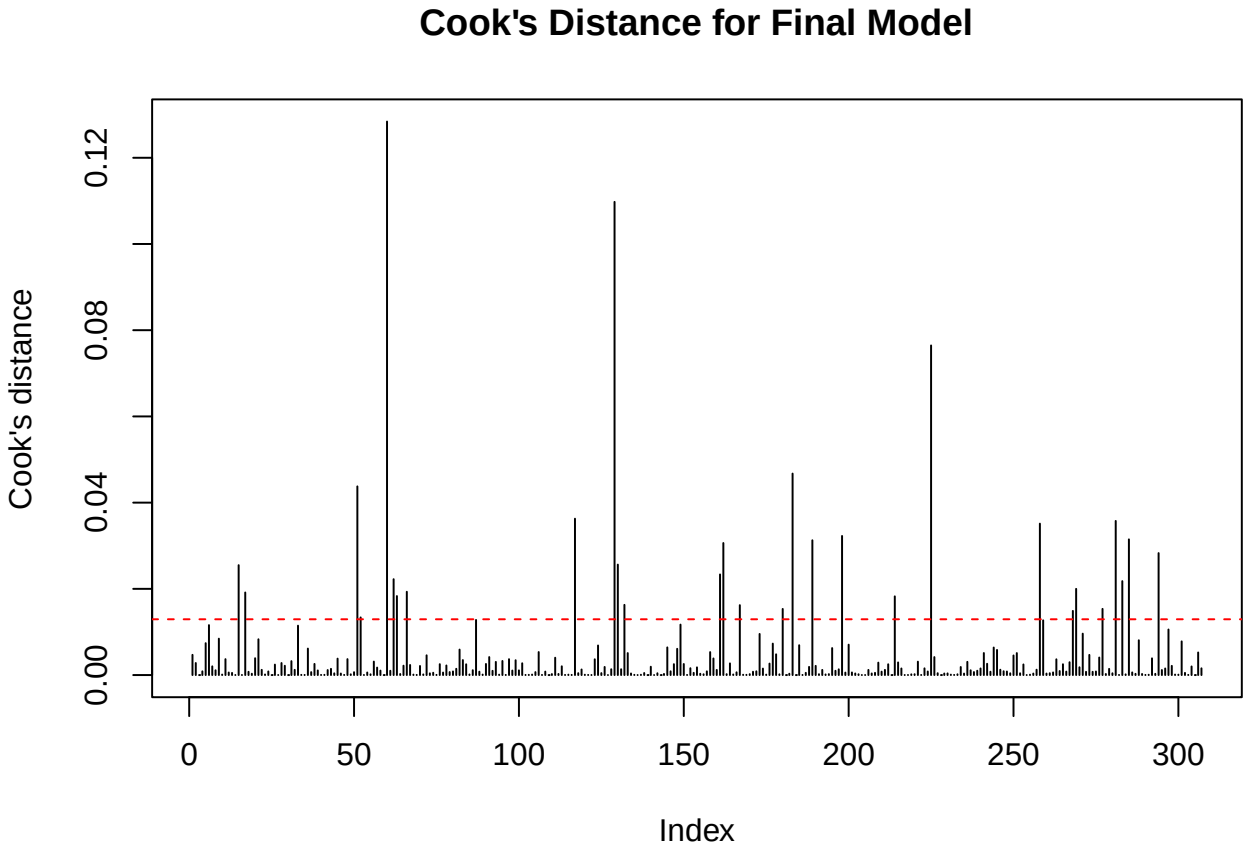


Figure A5

Cook's Distance for the Selected Regression Model



Code and data submission: Qianxue Wang